

Project of modern physics

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1 Introduction

Thanks to M. Akridas-Morel our referent professor during this project.

This project has been present in the purpose of understanding and modelling a specific case of a potential step, the barrier of potential.

The Python code is available on the GitHub page at the following link :

2 Generality about the Schrödinger Equation

In this part we will remind some important point about the Schrödinger Equation, and waves functions.

2.1 Generality

1. at 3 dimensions, a plane waves is write as :

$$\Psi(\vec{r}, t) = Ae^{i(\vec{k}\vec{r} - \omega t)}$$

with $\vec{k}$ the wave vector and ω the natural frequency.

- $[\vec{k}] = [\frac{2\pi}{\lambda}] = L^{-1}$
- $[\omega] = [\frac{2\pi}{T}] = T^{-1}$

2. At 1 dimension :

$$\Psi(x, t) = \Psi_0 e^{i(kx - \omega t)}$$

$$\Re(\Psi(x, t)) = \Psi_0 \cos(kx) \text{ and } \Im(\Psi(x, t)) = \Psi_0 \sin(\omega t)$$

3. To know the dimension of Ψ_0 we begin with the definition of the normalisation.

$$\begin{aligned}\int_{-\infty}^{+\infty} |\Psi(x, t)|^2 dx &= 1 \\ \Rightarrow [|\Psi_0|^2] * L &= 1 \\ \Rightarrow [\Psi_0] &= L^{-\frac{1}{2}} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{m}}\end{aligned}$$

4. If the particle is free, $V(x) = 0$. So with the Schrödinger Equation at 1 dimension :

$$\begin{aligned}-i\hbar \frac{\partial \Psi(x, t)}{\partial t} &= \frac{-\hbar^2}{2m} \frac{\partial^2 \Psi(x, t)}{\partial x^2} + V(x)\Psi(x, t) \\ \Rightarrow \hbar\omega \Psi(x, t) &= \frac{\hbar^2 k^2}{2m} \Psi(x, t) \\ \Rightarrow \hbar\omega &= \frac{\hbar^2 k^2}{2m}\end{aligned}$$

5. So with the previous question, we already have :

$$\omega(k) = \frac{\hbar k^2}{2m}$$

so :

$$\begin{aligned}v_\phi &= \frac{\omega(k)}{k} = \frac{\hbar k}{2m} \\ v_g &= \frac{d\omega(k)}{dk} = \frac{\hbar k}{m}\end{aligned}$$

6. let $v = p/m$.

We can notice that, $p = \hbar k$

Indeed, $p = h/\lambda$ and $\lambda = 2\pi/k$

So, $p = \hbar k/2\pi = \hbar k$ Thus, $v = v_g$ and $v = v_\phi/2$

7. The conditions for Ψ to be normalizable, is :

$$I = \int_{-\infty}^{+\infty} |\Psi(x, t)|^2 dx = 1$$

However, I diverge. So, Ψ isn't normalizable. If the problem was in a infinite barrier of potential, the boundaries were $[0, a]$.

8. As Ψ aren't normalizable, it's not a proper physical solution.

2.2 Superposition of plane waves

1. The Schrödinger Equation is a HLDE of order 2, so all linear combination of solutions remain solution. So as superposition of waves functions are a linear combination of waves functions, they remain solution of the Schrödinger Equation.

2. let at $t = 0$:

- $\Psi_1(x, 0) = \Psi_1 e^{ikx}$
- $\Psi_2(x, 0) = \frac{1}{2} \Psi_1 e^{i(k + \frac{\Delta k}{2})x}$
- $\Psi_3(x, 0) = \frac{1}{2} \Psi_1 e^{i(k - \frac{\Delta k}{2})x}$

let :

$$\begin{aligned}\Psi(x, 0) &= \Psi_1(x, 0) + \Psi_2(x, 0) + \Psi_3(x, 0) \\ &= \Psi_1 e^{ikx} \left(1 + \frac{1}{2} e^{i\frac{\Delta k}{2}} + \frac{1}{2} e^{-i\frac{\Delta k}{2}}\right) \\ &= \Psi_1 e^{ikx} \left(1 + \cos\left(\frac{\Delta k}{2}\right)\right)\end{aligned}$$

3.

$$\begin{aligned}\Psi_1 \Psi(x, 0)^* \Psi(x, 0) &= [|\Psi_1|^2 e^{ikx} e^{-ikx} (1 + \cos(\frac{\Delta k}{2}))^2] \\ &= |\Psi_1|^2 (1 + \cos(\frac{\Delta k}{2}))^2 \\ &= |\Psi_1|^2 (1 + 2 \cos(\frac{\Delta k}{2}) + \cos^2(\frac{\Delta k}{2})) \\ &= \rho(x)\end{aligned}$$

3 Waves packets

3.1 Gaussian waves packets

1. As we said before, $\omega = \frac{\hbar k^2}{2m}$
So with the solution in the statement, at 1 dimension :

$$\begin{aligned}\Psi(x, t) &= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2\pi}} \int g(k) e^{ikx - i\omega t} dk \\ &= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2\pi}} \int g(k) e^{ikx - i\frac{\hbar}{2m} k^2 t} dk\end{aligned}$$

2.

$$\begin{aligned}\Psi(x, t) &= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2\pi}} \int \frac{\sqrt{a}}{(2\pi)^{\frac{1}{4}}} e^{\frac{-a(k-k_0)^2}{4}} e^{ikx - i\frac{\hbar}{2m} k^2 t} dk \\ &= \frac{\sqrt{a}}{(2\pi)^{\frac{3}{4}}} \int e^{\frac{-a^2}{4}(k-k_0)^2 + 2\frac{a^2}{4} k k_0 + ikx - i\frac{\hbar}{2m} k^2 t} dk \\ &= \frac{\sqrt{a}}{(2\pi)^{\frac{3}{4}}} \int e^{\underbrace{-k^2(\frac{a^2}{4} + i\frac{\hbar}{2m}t)}_A + \underbrace{k(\frac{1}{2}a^2 k_0 + ix)}_B - \underbrace{\frac{a^2 k_0^2}{4}}_C} dk\end{aligned}$$

With the solution of a integral of the form :

$$I = \int e^{ax^2+bx+c} = \sqrt{\frac{\pi}{a}} e^{\frac{b^2}{4a}-c}$$

$$\Psi(x, t) = \alpha e^{u(k)}$$

We can notice that :

$$4A = a^2 + i \frac{2\hbar}{m} t$$

$$\begin{aligned} u(k) &= \frac{\frac{a^4 k_0^4}{4} + i a^2 k_0 x - x^2}{4A} - \frac{a^2 k_0^2}{4} \\ &= \frac{-x^2 + i(a^2 k_0 x - \frac{a^2 k_0^2 \hbar t}{2m})}{4A} \end{aligned}$$

So, in letting :

$$\omega(t)^2 = a \sqrt{1 + \left(\frac{2\hbar t}{ma^2} \right)^2} \text{ and } v_g = \frac{\hbar k}{m}$$

We have,

$$\Psi(x, t) = \underbrace{\left(\frac{2}{\pi \omega(t)^2} \right)^{\frac{1}{4}}}_{\Psi_0} e^{i\phi} e^{\frac{-2(x-v_g)^2}{\omega(t)^2}}$$